



Lecture 7

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Methods of Conducting Survey



Survey Methods

- Due to advancement in technology and communication, there is development in the areas of many survey methods.
- It is the responsibility of researcher to know about new and different mechanics of each method.
- The choice of survey method depends on situation.
- Few of the widely used methods are Personal interviews, telephonic interviews and mail interviews

Interviews

There are two ways of conducting interview

- Personal face-to-face interview
- Telephone interview
- In un-structured interview, face to face methods is used
- In structured interviews both (face-to-face & telephone) can be used depending upon the complexity of issue.
- Telephone interview is recommended where wide geographical area is population

Personal Face-to Face Interview

- Four entities are required to conduct it
 - The researcher
 - The interviewer
 - The interviewee
 - Interview environment
- Each requires general research knowledge & experience.
- Interviewer and interviewee can influence each other in an environment.



Door-to-Door Interviewing

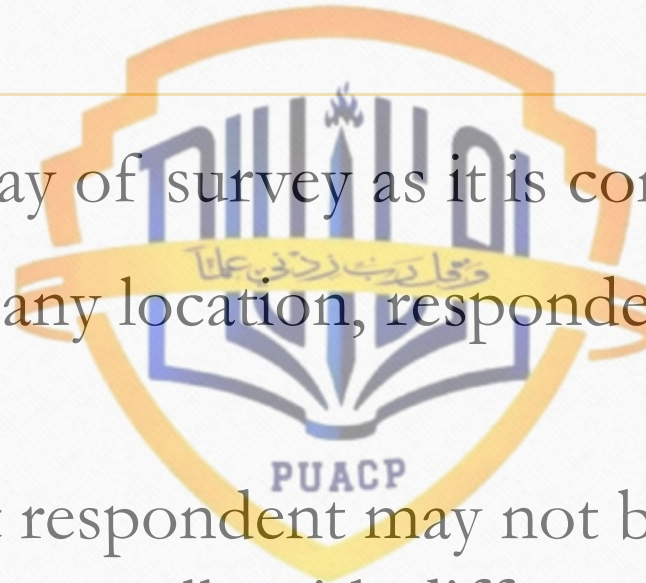
- This is the best survey method where respondents are interviewed at the door of their homes.
- This type has an advantage of personal interaction with respondent for complicated questions, which are made clear to him and clear feed back comes.
- This method is used when detailed in depth information is required about something.

Executive Interviewing

- Executive interviewing is conducted in market research from the business people at their offices to get detailed information about industrial product and services.
- It is time taking and expensive process as it requires qualified researcher and identification of questions.
- In next step permission and time is set to have an interview from executives.

Mall Intercept Surveys

- This is a cheapest way of survey as it is conducted in shopping malls.
- In shopping mall at any location, respondents are approached/invited randomly.
- only problem is that respondent may not be representative sample as they visit the shopping malls with different frequencies.



Self Administered Interview

- Self administered interview is done without interviewer.
- This is also a cheapest way
- It has one major disadvantage that no one is present to explain the questionnaire to respondent.
- This makes most of the answers unclear or without understanding it and makes the open ended questions useless.
- It is conducted, where researcher has easy access to captive audience.



Purchase Intercept Technique

- This is done in marketing research by in-store observations and in-store interviewing.
- This assesses the attitude and behavior of consumers about particular product that why they like it.
- Researcher observes keenly the customer, making a purchase of particular category.
- After the purchase researcher intercepts him/her and asks questions.



Advantages of Personal Interview

- A direct interview clear any ambiguity in the mind of respondent.
- Interviewer can pick nonverbal cues from the respondent.
- Researcher observes the body language of respondent and detect out the hidden things.
- In personal interview personal interest of researcher arises and increase the rate of participation.
- It helps in asking and explaining complex questions.
- It enhances the meaning of response with pictorial and mechanical aids.

Disadvantages of Personal Interview

- It has the disadvantage of geographical limitations that can not focus a wide range area.
- It requires high cost to train the interviewer to minimize the interviewer biasness.
- Sometimes respondent feels uneasy and uncomfortable about the secrecy of their responses.



Advantages of Telephone Interview

- It covers wide range of geographical area around the world.
- Researcher can collect information from any where around the world as his respondents are unlimited.
- It eliminates the element of discomfort of respondents.

Disadvantages of Telephone Interview

- Sometimes respondent unilaterally disconnects the calls and terminate the process of interview.
- Sometimes respondent has least interest in interview therefore the length of interview(10minutes recommended) must b minimized to create interest of respondent.
- The major drawback arises when questionnaire has maps, budgets illustrations or complex scale.

Mail Interview

- In this type of interview, the questionnaire is mailed to the respondents.
- The rate of response on mail interview is rather low in Pakistan due to lower literacy rate.
- A small percentage of educated people do respond.
- Questionnaire in Urdu or in regional languages do have better response.
- Moreover people in Pakistan are not research oriented thus the willingness to co-operate is low
- This method has high non-response even in developed countries as compare to other methods.

Steps of Mail Survey

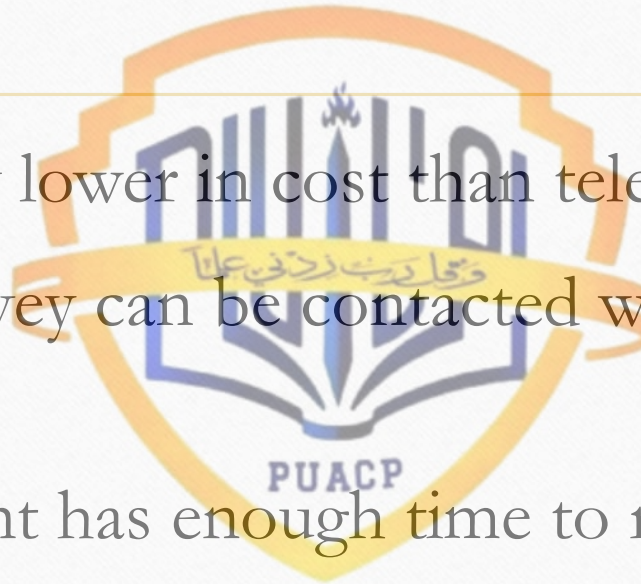
The steps of mail surveys are

- Identification of study participant.
- Mail interview package.
- Return envelope.
- Incentive, if they are.



Advantages of Mail Interview

- Mail surveys are typically lower in cost than telephone or personal interview.
- Respondents in mail survey can be contacted where telephone or other source is inaccessible.
- In mail survey respondent has enough time to reply and to think over questions.
- It is also considered more impersonal and provide more secrecy.



Disadvantages of Mail Interview

- It has one major drawback of strong biasness.
- Only interested respondent answers the mail.
- Large numbers of respondent normally do not respond.
- Even the answers in return are often unsatisfactory.
- Researcher has to do more effort to stimulate response by careful design, Skillful execution by completing unfilled or missed answers in one questionnaire.

THANKS

